

DigiTech TRIO Band Creator

A lonely guitarist's pal

With so much going on in life these days, it's not really possible for musicians to find time everyday to get together and jam. What this usually means as a guitarist is that you end up playing alone with no backing music, or you play to the same old static backing tracks that you have. DigiTech made the TRIO Band Creator exactly for the scenario we've just painted. A small pedal that can essentially give you the feel of having a drummer and a bassist to jam with. It tries to give you that feeling of jamming alone but having background sound at the same time to give you an illusion of musical grandeur

At first, it takes a little time to get used to the TRIO, but unlike us, if you watch the many YouTube videos featuring the TRIO before you begin using it, it will save you a lot of trouble. So yes, trial and error is good, but sometimes it's just easier to check out YouTube for helpful tutorials and videos of people who've actually used this product and other similar contraptions. Learn from their story, it will only help.

With 7 genres, 12 styles per genre, 3 parts recordable and tempo control to boot, the TRIO is really quite versatile, and to be honest, this writer isn't a good enough guitarist to really exploit its true potential. It certainly helps to know all seven genres available – Blues, Pop, Alternative, Rock, Country, R&b and Jazz. It also helps to simplify the rhythm you play in order to train the drums and bass – we tried to play complex riffs at first to train it and it was too confused to playback anything melodious. Play simple chords in as simplified a strumming method as possible for the riff you want, and it can really help you make interesting music. Using the three recordable parts, you can record a verse, bridge and chorus for the song, and switch between them while playing by holding down the main switch with your foot.



We could write an in-depth review of the TRIO, but there isn't enough space here for that. The bottom line is, if you find yourself playing guitar alone more often than you'd like, you need to save up and buy one of these. It's like having drummer and bassist pals, who are instantly on the same wavelength as you, allow you hone your riffing skills and let you experiment across the musical genres as well. What's more, you get all of this without having to tolerate any of the extra baggage that comes along with band mates.



SEIKO Velatura

Flick of da wrist

Batteries might be getting smaller and more efficient but there's a new wave of watches that have done away with it altogether... well almost. The SEIKO Velatura is an amalgamation of technology and class, and is relatable for the masses. You'd think kinetically powered watches might have a nasty whirring noise but there's none of that with the Velatura unless you call yourself an audiophile. Because then you're just nitpicking.

The SEIKO Velatura does have a small battery and circuitry to store time for its power save function. Being idle for 24 hours causes the watch to enter this mode and bring all mechanical operations to a halt. Moreover, it retains its charge for four years. So you can strap it on anytime and bring it to life with a flick of your wrist.